# Z8 Wi-Fi Photo Transfer

Each photo you take in the garage appears on your PC upstairs about 2 seconds later. No cable. One-time setup: about 20 minutes.

**Nikon Z8** → Wi-Fi → **your PC** → **C:\QDAM\Listings\Incoming** → **LAMP-042_01.jpg ...**

> **You need:** the Windows PC, the Z8 with a charged battery, your home Wi-Fi name and password, and about 20 minutes. Do Part A at the PC first, then Part B at the camera.

## Part A: Set up the PC (about 10 minutes)

1. ☐ Install **Python 3** from **python.org/downloads**. On the first install screen, tick **"Add python.exe to PATH"**.
2. ☐ Go to **github.com/xtresno/z8-wifi-drop**. Click the green **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**.
3. ☐ Unzip it to `C:\z8-wifi-drop`. Do not run it from the Downloads folder; it must stay where it is.
4. ☐ Double-click **Install.bat**. Click **Yes** when Windows asks for admin rights.
5. ☐ If it asks "Set the network to Private?", type **y** and press Enter.
6. ☐ When it finishes, open **"Z8 camera settings.txt"** on the desktop. Copy the values here:

| Setting | Write it here |
|---|---|
| Address (this PC) | |
| Port | **2121** (always) |
| User ID | **z8** (always) |
| Password (8 letters/numbers) | |
| Home Wi-Fi name | |

> **Tip:** the PC address can change when the router restarts. Ask whoever runs the router to give this PC a **fixed address** (called a "DHCP reservation"). Then you never need to change the camera again.

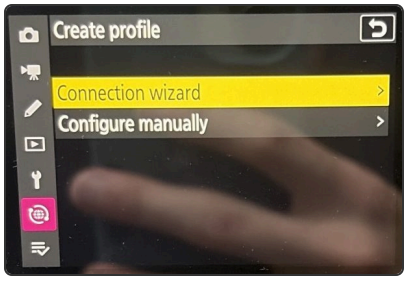
## Part B: Set up the camera (about 10 minutes)

To **save** typed text, press the **zoom-in (+) button**, above MENU. To **go back**, tap the ↺ arrow at the top right.

**1** **MENU** › **Network menu** (the globe icon). Check **Airplane mode** is **OFF**.

**2** **Connect to FTP server** › **Network settings** › **Create profile**.

**3** Pick **Configure manually**, not the wizard. The wizard uses port 21, which is wrong here.




Step 3: pick Configure manually.

**4** Pick **Wireless LAN**.

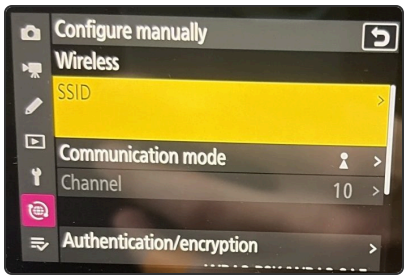
You now see the list **General / Wireless / TCP/IP / FTP**. Leave General as it is.




Step 4: Wireless LAN.

**5** **Wireless** › **SSID**: type the home Wi-Fi name **exactly**. Capitals count. Tap the letters on the screen. **Aa&** switches between capitals, small letters and symbols. The trash-can button deletes a letter.

**6** Leave **Authentication/encryption** as it is. Scroll down to **Password**: type the Wi-Fi password.

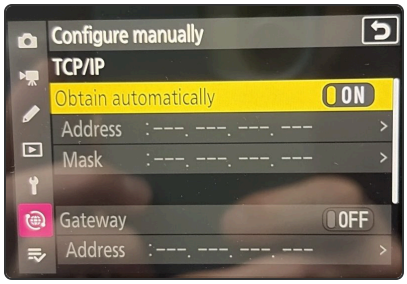



Step 5: SSID is the Wi-Fi name.




The keyboard. (+) button = save.

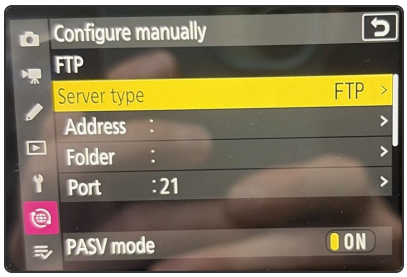
**7** Go back. **TCP/IP** › **Obtain automatically**: **ON**. Type nothing else here.




Step 7: Obtain automatically ON.

**8** Go back. **FTP**:

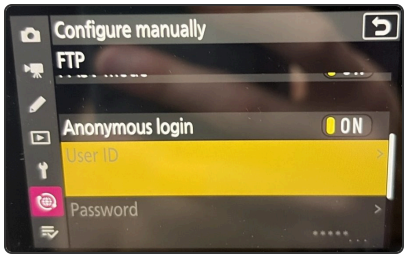
- **Server type**: FTP
- **Address**: the PC address from Part A. The dot (.) is on the symbols page (Aa&).
- **Folder**: leave blank
- **Port**: change **21** to **2121**. Left/right = move, up/down = change digit.
- **PASV mode**: ON




Before: Port says 21. Change it to 2121.

**9** Scroll down in FTP:

- **Anonymous login**: switch to **OFF**. It starts ON, and ON does **not** work.
- **User ID**: `z8` (small letters)
- **Password**: the 8-letter password from Part A (small letters)

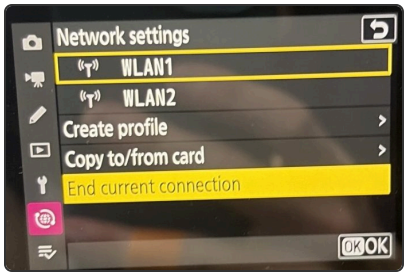



Wrong: Anonymous login ON. Switch it OFF, then fill in User ID and Password.

**10** Back out to **Network settings**. Highlight your profile (WLAN1, WLAN2 ...) and press **OK** to connect.

**"FTP" in green** on the shooting screen = connected. Red = error (see Part E).

To **edit** a profile later: highlight it and press **RIGHT**, not OK.




The yellow outline marks the profile in use.

## Part C: Upload options (one time, about 1 minute)

**MENU** › **Network menu** › **Connect to FTP server** › **Options**:

| Option | Set to | Why |
|---|---|---|
| Auto upload | **ON** | Every shot is sent by itself. |
| Upload RAW + JPEG as | **JPEG only** | A RAW file is 50 MB and takes 4.5 s; a JPEG takes 1.6 s. |
| Keep connection | **ON** | The camera reconnects after a Wi-Fi drop (uses more battery). |
| Overwrite if same name | **OFF** | A photo already sent is never replaced. |
| Delete after upload | **OFF** | The memory card stays as a backup. |

Also set the camera clock: **Setup menu** › **Time zone and date**. Match the PC clock, including daylight saving time.

## Part D: Every shoot

1. Turn on the camera. Wait for **"FTP" in green**.
2. On the PC, double-click **Z8 Photo Sorter** on the desktop.
3. Type the item ID (for example `LAMP-042`) and press Enter.
4. Shoot. Each photo becomes `LAMP-042_01.jpg`, `_02` ... in `C:\QDAM\Listings\LAMP-042\`.
5. Next item: wait until the last photo shows up, then type the next ID.

> **Two PCs, one camera?** Make one profile per PC (for example WLAN1 = upstairs PC, WLAN2 = other PC). The camera sends to one PC at a time: in **Network settings**, highlight the PC's profile and press **OK**.

## Part E: If something is wrong

| What you see | Do this |
|---|---|
| "FTP" is red on the camera | Check the Address, Port **2121**, User ID **z8**, and the password. Check that **Anonymous login is OFF**. |
| The camera cannot find the Wi-Fi | Retype the Wi-Fi name and password. Capitals count. Move the router or the camera closer. |
| It worked yesterday, not today | The PC address may have changed. Open "Z8 camera settings.txt", or run Install.bat again, and compare with the camera's Address. |
| No photos arrive, "FTP" is green | Options › **Auto upload ON**. Is the PC on and awake? |
| Photos are slow | Options › Upload RAW + JPEG as › **JPEG only**. Weak Wi-Fi in the garage: add a mesh node or access point there. |
| Anything else | Ask Claude Code (below). |

> **Ask Claude Code for help.** Open a terminal in `C:\z8-wifi-drop`, run `claude`, and say what you see, for example: *"the camera says FTP in red, help me fix it"*. It reads the logs on this PC and walks you through the camera menus one step at a time. Take photos of the camera screen and give them to it.

Measured on 2026-10-25: Z8 in the garage, router indoors. 0% packet loss; JPEG Fine (17 MB) in 1.6 s; RAW (50 MB) in 4.5 s. · github.com/xtresno/z8-wifi-drop